The concept of the data mesh appeared on the stage in 2019 and has since lit not just the data world, but the whole technology world, on fire. The data mesh concept breaks with the current world of data, which usually treats data as a by-product of software components. This new approach turns the spotlight on data producers and gives them the responsibility to handle the data just as they would handle their software.

With this, the data mesh takes the same journey software components have taken, with microservices architectures and with the DevOps movement. It takes the same journey frontends are currently taking with *microfrontends*. And just as in these examples, we believe that the data mesh is the right approach to finally gain the *flexibility to extract value from our data at scale*, be that in business intelligence (BI), ML learning, or any other use case you can think of.

The data mesh concept is often referred to as a *socio-technical* paradigm shift: its core is not about technology but about the alignment of people, processes, and organizations. This significant complexity is why we wrote this book. However, we don't just present the available theoretical knowledge that is out there; we focus on parts of the data mesh that are, in our experience, critical for successful implementation. We have organized those parts into a digestible resource to help you put a data mesh *in action*!

To guide you through the process, we've prepared hands-on examples with a lot of architecture sketches, describing various technologies, workshop techniques, team organization forms, and the like. After reading this book, you should be able to do the following:

- Evaluate whether a data mesh will suit your organization's business needs
- Lay the groundwork for data mesh development
- Develop a minimal data mesh to start your journey
- Keep iteratively developing and expanding your data mesh

Don't expect to find a lot of code in this book, other than a little JavaScript Object Notation (JSON) here and there. That's because we truly believe *the magic is not in the technology, but in the people, processes, and*